

Fat Loss

14-Day Companion Diet

Coach- and chef-built nutrition for the 12-Week Concurrent Block

- 14 unique days · 4 meals per day · every recipe different
- Training, rest, and refeed day macros scaled to bodyweight
- High protein, high volume, high fiber — engineered satiety
- Two weekly grocery lists with cost bands in US dollars
- Eating out, travel, supplements, and troubleshooting included

Coach- and chef-built nutrition program engineered for the TJFit Fat Loss 12-Week Concurrent Block (4 lifts + 2 conditioning + 1 long walk + 1 rest). This is a deficit. It is not a cleanse, not a detox, not a magic macro split. Numbers are calibrated to strip 350–450 g of fat per week from an intermediate male lifter at an 80 kg reference body without bleeding strength. Protein is high. Vegetables are high. Calories are honest. Cook the food. Hit the macros. Walk every day. The plan minimizes suffering; it does not eliminate it. Hunger is part of the deal — we manage it with volume, fiber, protein, water, sleep, caffeine, and structure.

1. Overview & Macros

1.1 Estimating maintenance calories

Use Mifflin–St Jeor for resting metabolic rate (RMR), then apply an activity multiplier. Track for two weeks before trusting any equation; the equation is a starting point, not a verdict.

Mifflin–St Jeor (men): $\text{RMR} = (10 \times \text{kg}) + (6.25 \times \text{cm}) - (5 \times \text{age}) + 5$ **Mifflin–St Jeor (women):** $\text{RMR} = (10 \times \text{kg}) + (6.25 \times \text{cm}) - (5 \times \text{age}) - 161$

Activity multiplier for this program (4 lifts + 2 conditioning + 1 long walk, desk job otherwise): **1.55**.

Worked example — 80 kg, 180 cm, 28-year-old male: - $\text{RMR} = (10 \times 80) + (6.25 \times 180) - (5 \times 28) + 5 = 800 + 1125 - 140 + 5 = 1790 \text{ kcal}$ - Maintenance = $1790 \times 1.55 = 2775 \text{ kcal}$ - Fat-loss deficit = $-450 \text{ kcal} \rightarrow \text{Target} = 2325 \text{ kcal/day}$

Deficit prescription: **–400 kcal** if you are already lean (sub-15% BF) or female, **–450 kcal** for the standard male presentation, **–500 kcal** only if BMI ≥ 28 and you have margin to give. Hard cap: **450 g/week (1 lb) scale loss averaged over 4 weeks**. Anything faster shreds muscle, tanks recovery, and breaks the program.

1.2 Macro split — training days (6/wk)

35% carbs / 40% protein / 25% fat. Protein anchored at **2.4 g/kg**.

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Light	65 kg	1900	170	165	53
Reference	80 kg	2325	195	205	65
Heavy	95 kg	2750	230	240	76

1.3 Macro split — rest days (Day 7, Day 14)

Drop carbs ~60 g, hold protein and fat steady. 22% carbs / 47% protein / 31% fat. Sodium up. Walk anyway — 8–10k steps minimum.

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Light	65 kg	1700	170	95	60
Reference	80 kg	2100	195	115	73

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Heavy	95 kg	2500	230	140	85

1.4 Macro split — refeed day (Day 5, Day 12; starts Week 5)

Eat at maintenance. Push carbs to **4.5 g/kg**. Drop fat under 50 g. This is not a cheat day. It is a structured restoration of leptin, thyroid output, glycogen, and training output. Use it on the heaviest training day of the week (Lower or Pull).

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Light	65 kg	2250	145	295	42
Reference	80 kg	2775	175	360	48
Heavy	95 kg	3300	205	425	55

Note: refeed protein drops to 2.2 g/kg because carbs do the muscle-sparing work. Fat goes low to make room for the carbs without exceeding maintenance.

1.5 Meal timing

- 4 meals/day: Breakfast (B), Lunch (L), Pre-workout snack (P), Dinner (D). No mandatory post-workout shake in a deficit — your next whole-food meal does the job.
- Breakfast within 60 min of waking. Protein first.
- Pre-workout snack 60–90 min before lifting: 30–45 g carbs + 25–30 g protein, fat under 10 g. Skip the carb portion of P on rest day and on conditioning-only days; eat just the protein + vegetables.
- Last meal 90 min before bed. Bias toward casein-style slow protein (cottage cheese, Greek yogurt) to blunt overnight hunger.
- Space meals 3.5–4 hours apart. Long gaps make compliance worse, not better.
- If you train fasted (early AM), front-load lunch to 600–700 kcal and shrink breakfast — but never under 30 g protein.

1.6 Hydration, electrolytes, fiber, micronutrients

- Water: 40 ml/kg/day floor (higher than the bulk plan; satiety + thermic dilution). 80 kg → 3.2 L. Add 500–750 ml per hour of training.
- Sodium: 4–6 g/day. Salt aggressively. Deficits drop blood pressure and waste sodium; under-salting causes headaches, cramps, and false hunger.
- Potassium: 4 g/day. Spinach, potatoes, bananas, yogurt, beans, avocado.
- Magnesium: 400 mg/day. Pumpkin seeds, almonds, dark chocolate, supplement if needed.
- Fiber: 35–45 g/day floor, non-negotiable. Fiber is the single best satiety lever you have.
- Micronutrient floor: 2 fruits + 600 g vegetables/day (a third more than the hypertrophy plan). One serving leafy greens, one cruciferous, one colored, daily.

1.7 Caffeine and diet sodas as tools

Both are useful, both are honest. Use them.

- Caffeine: 3–6 mg/kg/day, last dose $\geq$ 8 hours before bed. Bumps training output, blunts hunger, improves fat oxidation acutely. Coffee, espresso, green tea, pre-workout — all valid. Cap at 400 mg/day for most adults.
- Diet soda / zero drinks: Free. Use them when you want sweet and don't want calories. Aspartame, sucralose, stevia, ace-K are safe at consumed doses. Diet sodas at dinner significantly improve adherence for most people.
- Tea (green, black, herbal): Unlimited. Mint tea after dinner is one of the most reliable hunger killers known.
- Gum: Sugar-free gum at meal-prep, in the car, late evening. Cheap insurance.

2. The 14-Day Meal Plan

All macros target the **80 kg reference tier (2325 kcal training / 2100 kcal rest / 2775 kcal refeed)**. Scale linearly by bodyweight ratio (65 kg $\rightarrow$ multiply gram weights by 0.81; 95 kg $\rightarrow$ multiply by 1.19). Day 7 and Day 14 are rest days (lower carbs). Day 5 and Day 12 are refeed days (higher carbs, lower fat).

Meal slot key: **B** = Breakfast, **L** = Lunch, **P** = Pre-workout snack, **D** = Dinner.

Day 1 (Upper) — Mediterranean

1B — Smoked Salmon & Cottage Cheese Toast | 430 kcal · P 42 · C 38 · F 12 - 80 g sourdough (2 slices), 150 g 2% cottage cheese, 60 g cold-smoked salmon, 80 g cucumber, 20 g red onion, 5 g capers, 2 g dill, 10 ml lemon juice, 1 g black pepper, 1 g flaky salt. - Cook time: 6 min. Easy. 1. Toast sourdough until firm, 3 min. 2. Stir cottage cheese with dill, pepper, half the lemon juice. 3. Spread 75 g cottage cheese per slice. 4. Drape 30 g salmon over each slice. 5. Top with sliced cucumber and onion, scatter capers. 6. Finish with remaining lemon juice and flaky salt. - Swap 1: cottage cheese $\rightarrow$ 0% Greek yogurt at 180 g. - Swap 2: salmon $\rightarrow$ 70 g chicken breast, sliced thin. - Coach: cottage cheese has the casein curve. Eat it slow.

1L — Chicken Shawarma Bowl | 580 kcal · P 55 · C 55 · F 16 - 180 g chicken breast, 150 g cooked basmati (50 g dry), 200 g romaine, 80 g cucumber, 80 g tomato, 60 g red cabbage (shredded), 30 g pickled turnip, 80 g low-fat tzatziki (recipe §5.5), 5 g shawarma spice (recipe §5.4), 10 ml olive oil, 5 ml lemon, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 18 min. Easy. 1. Cube chicken, toss with shawarma spice, 5 ml olive oil, salt. 2. Sear in a hot dry pan 4 min per side until charred edges, 73°C / 165°F internal. 3. Cook rice with 1 g salt per 50 g dry, simmer 12 min covered, rest 5. 4. Shred romaine and cabbage, slice cucumber and tomato. 5. Build bowl: rice base, vegetables fanned, chicken on top. 6. Spoon tzatziki across, scatter turnip, finish with remaining oil, lemon, salt. - Swap 1: chicken $\rightarrow$ 200 g 95% lean ground turkey. - Swap 2: rice $\rightarrow$ 200 g cooked freekeh (60 g dry). - Coach: shawarma spice is half the meal. Toast it 30 sec in the dry pan before adding chicken.

1P — Apple, Whey, Almonds | 320 kcal · P 32 · C 32 · F 8 - 1 medium apple (180 g), 30 g whey isolate in 300 ml water, 12 g raw almonds. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Shake whey in 300 ml cold water 20 sec. 2. Slice apple. 3. Count out almonds (about 10). - Swap 1: apple $\rightarrow$ 1 pear (180 g). - Swap 2: whey $\rightarrow$ 200 g 0% Greek yogurt + 5 g honey. - Coach: this lands 75 min before the Upper session. No fat-heavy snacks pre-lift.

1D — Sheet-Pan Lemon-Herb Cod & Greens | 480 kcal · P 48 · C 38 · F 14 - 200 g cod loin, 300 g broccoli florets, 200 g cherry tomatoes, 180 g baby potatoes (halved), 10 ml olive oil, 8 g garlic (minced), 1 lemon (zest + 15 ml juice), 3

g oregano, 2 g paprika, 2 g salt, 1 g black pepper, 5 g parsley. - Cook time: 28 min. Easy. 1. Heat oven to 220°C / 425°F. 2. Toss potatoes with 5 ml oil, salt; roast 12 min on a sheet pan. 3. Pat cod dry, season with paprika, lemon zest, half the garlic, salt, pepper. 4. Add broccoli, tomatoes, remaining garlic, remaining oil to the pan; toss. 5. Lay cod on top; roast 12 min until cod flakes at 60°C / 140°F. 6. Finish with oregano, lemon juice, chopped parsley. - Swap 1: cod → 200 g haddock or pollock. - Swap 2: potatoes → 200 g roasted carrots and parsnips. - Coach: cod overcooks in seconds. Pull at 60°C / 140°F; carryover finishes it.

Day 2 (Lower) — Asian (Japanese/Korean)

2B — Tamago Oats with Spinach | 470 kcal · P 38 · C 50 · F 12 - 60 g rolled oats, 250 ml water, 3 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 120 g spinach, 8 g soy sauce, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g toasted sesame, 2 g black pepper, 80 g kimchi. - Cook time: 10 min. Easy. 1. Simmer oats in water with a pinch of salt 5 min, set aside. 2. Wilt spinach in a dry pan 90 sec, season with soy and sesame oil. 3. Scramble eggs + whites in the pan on medium-low until just set, 2 min. 4. Plate oats, spinach, eggs side by side. 5. Top eggs with sesame seeds, pepper, kimchi on the side. - Swap 1: oats → 180 g cooked sushi rice (60 g dry). - Swap 2: spinach → 120 g bok choy. - Coach: kimchi is the cheapest, hardest-working condiment in the fridge. Use it.

2L — Korean Beef Bowl (Bulgogi-Style) | 600 kcal · P 52 · C 58 · F 16 - 170 g 95% lean ground beef, 150 g cooked jasmine rice (50 g dry), 100 g shredded carrots, 100 g cucumber, 80 g bean sprouts, 50 g kimchi, 1 egg, 15 ml soy sauce, 8 g garlic, 5 g ginger (grated), 5 g brown sugar, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g gochujang, 5 g toasted sesame, 1 spring onion. - Cook time: 20 min. Medium. 1. Cook rice while everything else preps, 12 min covered. 2. Whisk soy, garlic, ginger, sugar, gochujang, half the sesame oil. 3. Brown beef in a hot pan 5 min, breaking it up; drain any standing fat. 4. Add sauce, simmer 90 sec until glossy. 5. Quick-blanch sprouts 60 sec in salted water. 6. Fry egg in remaining sesame oil, sunny-side up. 7. Build bowl: rice, beef, carrots, cucumber, sprouts, kimchi in zones. 8. Top with egg, sesame, sliced spring onion. - Swap 1: ground beef → 180 g chicken thigh, sliced. - Swap 2: jasmine rice → 200 g cauliflower rice + 80 g rice for half the carbs. - Coach: 95% lean is the line. 85% turns this meal into a 750 kcal disaster.

2P — Banana, Whey, Rice Cakes | 330 kcal · P 30 · C 50 · F 3 - 1 banana (120 g), 30 g whey isolate in 300 ml water, 2 rice cakes (18 g), 15 g honey. - Cook time: 2 min. Easy. 1. Shake whey in cold water 20 sec. 2. Slice banana, eat with rice cakes drizzled with honey. - Swap 1: rice cakes → 30 g cornflakes dry. - Swap 2: banana → 150 g pineapple. - Coach: highest-carb, lowest-fat pre-workout of the week. Lower day demands glycogen.

3D — see Day 3. (Day 2D below.)

2D — Miso-Glazed Salmon, Edamame, Brown Rice | 600 kcal · P 48 · C 50 · F 22 - 170 g salmon fillet, 120 g cooked brown rice (40 g dry), 150 g shelled edamame, 200 g tenderstem broccoli, 12 g white miso, 8 g mirin, 8 g rice vinegar, 5 g grated ginger, 5 g sesame oil, 3 g chili flakes, 5 g sesame seeds, 1 spring onion. - Cook time: 18 min. Medium. 1. Heat oven to 200°C / 400°F. 2. Whisk miso, mirin, vinegar, ginger. 3. Brush salmon with glaze; bake 11 min until 52°C / 125°F internal for medium. 4. Steam broccoli 4 min, then toss with sesame oil and chili. 5. Boil edamame in salted water 4 min, drain, salt. 6. Plate rice, salmon on top, broccoli and edamame around. 7. Finish with sesame seeds and sliced spring onion. - Swap 1: salmon → 180 g sea bass. - Swap 2: brown rice → 150 g soba noodles cooked. - Coach: salmon's fat counts; this is your fat-anchor meal for the day. Don't add oil elsewhere.

Day 3 (Push) — Mexican

3B — Huevos Rancheros, Light | 440 kcal · P 38 · C 42 · F 14 - 2 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 1 corn tortilla (30 g), 100 g black beans (canned, drained), 80 g canned diced tomatoes, 40 g red onion, 8 g jalapeño, 5 g garlic, 30 g 2%

cottage cheese (queso fresco style), 10 g cilantro, 2 g cumin, 2 g smoked paprika, 1 g salt, 5 ml olive oil, 15 ml lime juice. - Cook time: 12 min. Easy. 1. Sauté onion, garlic, jalapeño in oil 3 min. 2. Add tomatoes, cumin, paprika, salt; simmer 4 min. 3. Stir in black beans, warm through. 4. Toast tortilla in a dry pan 60 sec per side. 5. In a non-stick pan, fry eggs + whites mixed together, 2 min. 6. Plate tortilla, beans, eggs. 7. Top with crumbled cottage cheese, cilantro, lime. - Swap 1: corn tortilla → 1 small flour tortilla (30 g). - Swap 2: black beans → 100 g pinto beans. - Coach: hot sauce is free. Cholula, Tapatío, Valentina — pick one and live there.

3L — Chicken Burrito Bowl | 600 kcal · P 55 · C 65 · F 12 - 180 g chicken breast, 130 g cooked white rice (45 g dry), 80 g black beans, 100 g romaine, 80 g salsa (pico de gallo), 60 g salsa verde, 30 g pickled jalapeños, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt (as crema), 10 g cilantro, 8 g taco spice (recipe §5.4), 5 ml olive oil, 15 ml lime juice, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 16 min. Easy. 1. Cube chicken, toss with taco spice, oil, salt. 2. Sear in a hot pan 4 min per side until 73°C / 165°F internal. 3. Warm beans with a splash of water and a pinch of cumin. 4. Build bowl: rice base, lettuce ring, beans, chicken, both salsas, jalapeños. 5. Thin yogurt with lime juice; drizzle as crema. 6. Top with cilantro. - Swap 1: chicken → 180 g 96% lean ground beef. - Swap 2: white rice → 200 g cauliflower rice + 50 g black beans extra. - Coach: skip cheese. Skip guacamole. Both kill your fat budget at lunch. The yogurt-lime crema does the cooling job for 90 fewer kcal.

3P — Cottage Cheese, Pineapple, Crackers | 290 kcal · P 28 · C 32 · F 5 - 200 g 2% cottage cheese, 120 g pineapple chunks (fresh), 4 rye crackers (28 g), 1 g cinnamon. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Spoon cottage cheese into a bowl. 2. Top with pineapple, dust with cinnamon. 3. Eat crackers alongside. - Swap 1: cottage cheese → 200 g 0% Greek yogurt. - Swap 2: pineapple → 150 g mango. - Coach: this is 75 min pre-Push. Bromelain in pineapple helps with protein digestion; the carb-protein ratio is engineered for upper-body pressing.

3D — Shrimp Fajita Skillet | 510 kcal · P 48 · C 48 · F 14 - 200 g shrimp (peeled), 200 g bell peppers (mixed), 120 g onion, 1 small flour tortilla (40 g) or 100 g cooked black beans, 60 g salsa verde, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 10 g cilantro, 8 g fajita spice (cumin 3 g + paprika 2 g + oregano 1 g + garlic powder 1 g + chili 1 g), 8 ml olive oil, 15 ml lime, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 14 min. Easy. 1. Slice peppers and onion into strips. 2. Heat 5 ml oil in cast iron over high; add peppers and onion, char 5 min. 3. Push to one side, add shrimp with spice mix and remaining oil. 4. Sear shrimp 90 sec per side until pink and opaque, 60°C / 140°F internal. 5. Toss everything, finish with lime juice and salt. 6. Serve in warm tortilla or over beans, top with salsa verde, yogurt, cilantro. - Swap 1: shrimp → 200 g chicken breast strips. - Swap 2: tortilla → 150 g cauliflower rice. - Coach: char is flavor, not failure. Get the pan smoking before the peppers go in.

Day 4 (Pull) — Indian

4B — Masala Egg White Scramble & Roti | 420 kcal · P 40 · C 42 · F 10 - 200 g egg whites + 1 whole egg, 1 whole wheat roti (50 g), 100 g tomato, 60 g onion, 60 g spinach, 5 g ginger, 5 g garlic, 1 green chili, 5 ml ghee, 2 g cumin seeds, 2 g garam masala (recipe §5.4), 1 g turmeric, 1 g salt, 5 g cilantro. - Cook time: 10 min. Easy. 1. Heat ghee in a non-stick pan, bloom cumin seeds 30 sec. 2. Add chopped onion, ginger, garlic, chili; sauté 3 min. 3. Add tomato, turmeric, salt; cook 2 min until tomatoes break down. 4. Add spinach, wilt 60 sec. 5. Pour in whisked eggs + whites; scramble on medium-low until just set, 2 min. 6. Finish with garam masala and cilantro. 7. Warm roti in a dry pan 30 sec per side. - Swap 1: roti → 2 corn tortillas (60 g). - Swap 2: ghee → 5 g olive oil. - Coach: bloom whole spices first. It is the difference between Indian food and seasoned food.

4L — Chicken Tikka Salad with Mint Yogurt | 540 kcal · P 55 · C 35 · F 18 - 200 g chicken breast, 250 g cucumber, 150 g cherry tomato, 100 g red onion, 100 g romaine, 80 g chickpeas (canned, drained), 50 g 0% Greek yogurt (marinade) + 80 g for sauce, 8 g tikka masala blend (paprika 3 g + cumin 2 g + coriander 2 g + garam masala 1 g), 5 g ginger, 5 g garlic, 10 g mint, 10 ml lemon juice, 5 ml olive oil, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 22 min (incl. marinade). Medium. 1. Cube chicken, marinate in 50 g yogurt + spices + ginger + garlic + half the lemon, minimum 15 min. 2. Skewer or spread on a foil-lined tray; broil 4 min per side, 73°C / 165°F internal. 3. Chop cucumber, tomato, onion, romaine; toss

with oil, salt, remaining lemon. 4. Drain and rinse chickpeas; fold into salad. 5. Blend 80 g yogurt with mint, pinch of salt, splash of water for sauce. 6. Plate salad, lay chicken on top, drizzle mint yogurt. - Swap 1: chicken → 200 g paneer (note: fat budget changes — drop oil to 0 g). - Swap 2: chickpeas → 80 g cooked lentils. - Coach: 15 min marinade minimum. 4 hours if you planned ahead. The acid in yogurt tenderizes; the spice penetrates.

4P — Mango Lassi Protein Shake | 310 kcal · P 32 · C 38 · F 4 - 30 g whey isolate, 150 g frozen mango, 150 g 0% Greek yogurt, 200 ml water, 1 g cardamom, 5 g honey, ice. - Cook time: 2 min. Easy. 1. Blend everything 30 sec. 2. Pour over ice. - Swap 1: mango → 150 g frozen pineapple. - Swap 2: whey → 60 g additional Greek yogurt + 5 g honey (lower protein, plan accordingly). - Coach: blends with cardamom taste like an actual lassi. Without it, it tastes like a protein shake with mango.

4D — Dal Tadka, Cauliflower Sabzi, Tandoori Chicken | 600 kcal · P 55 · C 55 · F 14 - 60 g red lentils (dry), 120 g chicken breast, 250 g cauliflower, 80 g onion, 100 g tomato, 5 g ginger, 5 g garlic, 1 green chili, 5 ml ghee, 2 g cumin seeds, 1 g mustard seeds, 1 g turmeric, 2 g coriander powder, 2 g garam masala, 5 g tandoori masala, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 10 ml lemon, 5 g cilantro, 1.5 g salt. - Cook time: 30 min. Medium. 1. Simmer lentils in 400 ml water with turmeric and 1 g salt, 20 min until soft. 2. While lentils cook, marinate chicken in yogurt + tandoori masala + half the ginger + half the lemon, 10 min. 3. Broil chicken 5 min per side until 73°C / 165°F internal. 4. For sabzi: heat 3 ml ghee, sizzle mustard + cumin seeds, add onion and remaining ginger/garlic, cook 4 min; add cauliflower, coriander powder, 80 ml water; cover and steam 8 min; finish with garam masala and tomato. 5. For dal tadka: heat 2 ml ghee, add chili, pour over cooked lentils. 6. Plate dal, sabzi, sliced chicken; finish with cilantro and lemon. - Swap 1: chicken → 150 g grilled prawns. - Swap 2: cauliflower → 250 g eggplant chunks. - Coach: the tadka — the spiced ghee finish — is what makes dal restaurant-grade. Do not skip it to save 2 g of fat.

Day 5 (Lower — REFEED day, starting Week 5) — Italian

Macro target today: 2775 kcal / P 175 / C 360 / F 48. Eat the carbs. Drop the fat. Train hard.

5B — Banana Pancakes with Berry Compote | 600 kcal · P 38 · C 90 · F 6 - 90 g rolled oats, 250 g egg whites, 1 banana, 200 g blueberries, 100 g raspberries, 15 g honey, 5 g cinnamon, 5 g vanilla, 5 g baking powder, 2 g salt, cooking spray. - Cook time: 15 min. Easy. 1. Blend oats, egg whites, banana, cinnamon, vanilla, baking powder, salt into a batter. 2. Cook pancakes in a non-stick pan (spray) 90 sec per side over medium, makes ~6 cakes. 3. Simmer berries with honey and 30 ml water 4 min until syrupy. 4. Stack pancakes, ladle compote across. - Swap 1: oats → 80 g flour. - Swap 2: berries → 200 g cherries. - Coach: refeed breakfasts hit hard. The glycogen pull from yesterday's Pull session is real.

5L — Spaghetti Pomodoro with Grilled Chicken | 750 kcal · P 60 · C 105 · F 12 - 120 g spaghetti (dry), 180 g chicken breast, 300 g canned San Marzano tomatoes, 8 g garlic, 10 g basil, 5 ml olive oil, 20 g parmesan, 2 g chili flakes, 5 g oregano, 2 g salt, 10 ml balsamic. - Cook time: 25 min. Medium. 1. Boil pasta in 2 L salted water (10 g salt) to al dente, 9 min; reserve 200 ml pasta water. 2. Pound chicken to 1.5 cm thickness, season with salt, oregano, balsamic. 3. Grill chicken 4 min per side, rest 3 min, slice. 4. In a wide pan, warm oil; sizzle garlic 30 sec, add tomatoes (hand-crushed), chili. 5. Simmer 8 min until thick. 6. Drain pasta, toss in the sauce with 60 ml pasta water and torn basil. 7. Plate pasta, lay chicken on top, finish with parmesan. - Swap 1: spaghetti → 120 g linguine. - Swap 2: parmesan → 30 g ricotta (still low-fat). - Coach: pasta water is the sauce-binder. Always reserve it.

5P — Rice Cakes, Honey, Whey | 320 kcal · P 30 · C 50 · F 2 - 4 rice cakes (36 g), 25 g honey, 30 g whey isolate in 300 ml water, 5 g cinnamon. - Cook time: 2 min. Easy. 1. Drizzle honey across rice cakes, dust with cinnamon. 2. Shake whey separately. - Swap 1: rice cakes → 60 g corn cakes. - Swap 2: honey → 30 g jam. - Coach: highest-carb, lowest-fat snack on the plan. Engineered for a heavy Lower session.

5D — Risotto Milanese with Shrimp | 1100 kcal · P 50 · C 115 · F 28 - 110 g arborio rice (dry), 200 g shrimp, 800 ml chicken stock, 80 g onion, 8 g garlic, 50 ml dry white wine, 0.2 g saffron, 30 g parmesan, 20 g butter, 10 ml olive oil, 200 g asparagus, 10 g parsley, 15 ml lemon juice, 2 g salt, 1 g black pepper. - Cook time: 35 min. Medium. 1. Warm stock in a small pot; steep saffron in 50 ml of it. 2. Sauté onion in oil 4 min, add garlic 30 sec, then rice; toast 90 sec. 3. Add wine, stir until absorbed. 4. Add stock one ladle at a time, stirring; cook 18 min until rice is al dente and creamy. 5. Stir in saffron stock toward the end. 6. Off heat, mantecare with butter and parmesan. 7. Sear shrimp in a separate pan 90 sec per side with a pinch of salt. 8. Roast or steam asparagus 5 min. 9. Plate risotto, shrimp, asparagus; finish with parsley, pepper, lemon. - Swap 1: shrimp → 180 g chicken breast. - Swap 2: asparagus → 200 g zucchini. - Coach: refeed dinner. Eat it slow. Sleep deep. Wake up stronger.

Day 6 (Conditioning + Push or Pull touch-up) — Middle Eastern

6B — Shakshuka with Feta | 430 kcal · P 36 · C 28 · F 18 - 3 whole eggs, 100 g egg whites, 400 g canned crushed tomatoes, 100 g bell pepper, 80 g onion, 8 g garlic, 30 g low-fat feta, 5 g cumin, 5 g paprika, 2 g chili flakes, 5 ml olive oil, 10 g parsley, 1 g salt, 50 g sourdough (1 slice). - Cook time: 18 min. Medium. 1. Sauté onion and pepper in oil 5 min in a cast iron skillet. 2. Add garlic, cumin, paprika, chili; bloom 30 sec. 3. Pour in tomatoes and salt; simmer 6 min until thick. 4. Make wells, crack eggs in, pour egg whites around. 5. Cover, cook on low 5 min until whites set, yolks still runny. 6. Crumble feta, scatter parsley. 7. Serve with toasted sourdough. - Swap 1: feta → 30 g goat cheese. - Swap 2: sourdough → 1 whole wheat pita (50 g). - Coach: classic Middle East cooks shakshuka with way more oil. We don't need it; the tomatoes carry the flavor.

6L — Lamb Kofta with Tabbouleh | 580 kcal · P 50 · C 50 · F 18 - 180 g 90% lean ground lamb (or 90% lean beef), 60 g bulgur (dry), 200 g flat-leaf parsley, 100 g tomato, 80 g cucumber, 40 g red onion, 5 g garlic, 5 g mint, 6 g shawarma spice (recipe §5.4), 10 ml olive oil, 20 ml lemon juice, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 1.5 g salt. - Cook time: 18 min. Medium. 1. Soak bulgur in 120 ml boiling water 12 min, drain, fluff. 2. Mix lamb with half the garlic, shawarma spice, 1 g salt; form 4 koftas. 3. Grill or pan-sear 4 min per side, 71°C / 160°F internal. 4. Finely chop parsley, mint, tomato, cucumber, onion. 5. Combine with bulgur, oil, lemon juice, remaining garlic, salt. 6. Plate tabbouleh, lay koftas, dollop yogurt. - Swap 1: lamb → 180 g lean ground beef. - Swap 2: bulgur → 60 g quinoa (dry). - Coach: 90% is the lowest fat you can run on lamb without it tasting like cardboard.

6P — Greek Yogurt, Honey, Pistachios | 280 kcal · P 28 · C 28 · F 7 - 200 g 0% Greek yogurt, 15 g honey, 10 g pistachios, 1 g cinnamon. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Top yogurt with honey, pistachios, cinnamon. - Swap 1: yogurt → 200 g 2% skyr. - Swap 2: pistachios → 10 g walnuts. - Coach: today's pre-workout is conditioning-only. Carbs moderate, not high.

6D — Falafel-Spiced Chicken with Hummus & Roasted Vegetables | 590 kcal · P 55 · C 52 · F 16 - 200 g chicken breast, 80 g hummus, 200 g eggplant, 200 g zucchini, 150 g bell pepper, 80 g onion, 50 g whole wheat pita (½ pita), 8 g falafel spice (cumin 3 g + coriander 3 g + garlic powder 1 g + cardamom 1 g), 10 ml olive oil, 15 ml lemon juice, 10 g parsley, 1.5 g salt, 2 g sumac. - Cook time: 30 min. Easy. 1. Heat oven to 220°C / 425°F. 2. Cube vegetables, toss with 5 ml oil, salt; roast 22 min, flip at 12. 3. Rub chicken with falafel spice, 1 g salt, remaining oil. 4. Grill or pan-sear chicken 5 min per side, 73°C / 165°F internal. 5. Warm pita 30 sec. 6. Plate hummus as a base, lay sliced chicken and vegetables. 7. Finish with lemon, parsley, sumac. - Swap 1: chicken → 200 g whitefish. - Swap 2: hummus → 100 g baba ganoush (slightly higher fat — adjust other meal). - Coach: sumac is the single most underused spice in a Western kitchen. Tangy, citrusy, not sour. Buy a jar.

Day 7 (REST DAY) — American (lower carb)

Macro target today: 2100 kcal / P 195 / C 115 / F 73. Walk 8–10k steps. No training.

7B — Spinach & Feta Omelette with Avocado | 460 kcal · P 38 · C 14 · F 26 - 3 whole eggs, 80 g egg whites, 100 g spinach, 30 g low-fat feta, 60 g avocado, 50 g cherry tomato, 5 ml olive oil, 1 g salt, 1 g pepper, 3 g chives. - Cook time: 8 min. Easy. 1. Whisk eggs + whites with salt and pepper. 2. Heat oil in non-stick pan; wilt spinach 60 sec, remove. 3. Pour eggs in, swirl, when 80% set add spinach and feta down the center. 4. Fold and slide onto plate. 5. Top with sliced avocado, halved tomatoes, chives. - Swap 1: avocado → 15 g olive oil drizzle. - Swap 2: feta → 30 g goat cheese. - Coach: rest day fat goes up. This is on purpose. You need the satiety on a no-training day.

7L — Cobb-Style Power Salad | 580 kcal · P 55 · C 22 · F 28 - 180 g chicken breast, 2 boiled eggs, 30 g blue cheese, 60 g avocado, 200 g romaine, 100 g tomato, 80 g cucumber, 60 g red onion, 50 g bacon (lean, 2 strips), 15 g red wine vinegar, 10 ml olive oil, 5 g Dijon mustard, 1 g salt, 1 g pepper. - Cook time: 18 min. Easy. 1. Season chicken with salt and pepper; pan-sear 5 min per side, rest, slice. 2. Boil eggs 9 min, ice, peel, quarter. 3. Crisp bacon in a dry pan 4 min, blot, crumble. 4. Chop lettuce, tomato, cucumber, onion. 5. Whisk vinegar, oil, mustard, salt for vinaigrette. 6. Arrange salad in rows: lettuce base, then chicken, egg, avocado, blue cheese, bacon. 7. Drizzle dressing. - Swap 1: blue cheese → 30 g sharp cheddar. - Swap 2: bacon → 60 g smoked turkey. - Coach: classic Cobb is 1100 kcal. This is 580. The cuts: less cheese, less bacon, real vinaigrette instead of ranch.

7P — Cottage Cheese & Berries | 220 kcal · P 28 · C 18 · F 4 - 200 g 2% cottage cheese, 100 g strawberries, 80 g raspberries, 5 g vanilla extract, 1 g cinnamon. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Stir vanilla into cottage cheese. 2. Top with berries and cinnamon. - Swap 1: cottage cheese → 200 g 0% skyr. - Swap 2: berries → 100 g cherries. - Coach: rest-day P slot is just a snack. No carb anchoring needed.

7D — Rib-Eye Cap, Sweet Potato Mash, Charred Broccolini | 840 kcal · P 74 · C 60 · F 36 - 200 g lean rib-eye cap (spinalis) or 220 g sirloin trimmed, 200 g sweet potato, 250 g broccolini, 20 g butter, 8 g garlic, 5 g rosemary, 5 g thyme, 10 ml olive oil, 2 g salt, 2 g pepper, 30 ml beef stock, 5 ml lemon juice. - Cook time: 30 min. Medium. 1. Roast sweet potato whole at 200°C / 400°F 25 min until soft. 2. Salt steak 40 min before cooking, dry-brine. 3. Heat cast iron screaming hot, sear steak 3 min per side, baste with butter, garlic, rosemary, thyme last 90 sec. 4. Rest steak 6 min; target 54°C / 130°F medium-rare. 5. Mash sweet potato with 5 g butter, salt, pepper. 6. Char broccolini in steak pan 4 min with oil; finish with lemon. 7. Plate, slice steak against the grain. - Swap 1: rib-eye → 220 g pork tenderloin (lower fat — adjust earlier meals up by 8 g fat). - Swap 2: sweet potato → 200 g roasted carrots. - Coach: rest-day fat ceiling. Don't add cheese to anything else today.

Day 8 (Upper) — Mediterranean / Spanish

8B — Mediterranean Egg Toast | 440 kcal · P 38 · C 40 · F 14 - 80 g sourdough (2 slices), 2 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 80 g cherry tomato, 60 g cucumber, 60 g hummus (light), 40 g red onion, 10 g parsley, 2 g sumac, 5 ml olive oil, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 10 min. Easy. 1. Toast bread. 2. Slow-scramble eggs + whites in oil with salt, 3 min. 3. Halve tomatoes; slice cucumber and onion. 4. Spread hummus on toast. 5. Top with eggs, vegetables, parsley, sumac. - Swap 1: hummus → 60 g mashed avocado. - Swap 2: sourdough → 1 whole wheat pita. - Coach: hummus carries the fat budget. Pick a real one or make it (chickpea 200 g, tahini 30 g, lemon, garlic, salt, water — blended).

8L — Spanish Tuna & White Bean Salad | 560 kcal · P 50 · C 50 · F 14 - 1 can tuna in water (150 g drained), 150 g cannellini beans (canned), 200 g roasted red peppers, 100 g cherry tomato, 60 g red onion, 80 g cucumber, 20 g olives (pitted), 10 g parsley, 12 ml olive oil, 15 ml red wine vinegar, 5 g Dijon, 5 g smoked paprika, 1 g salt, 60 g baguette (small piece). - Cook time: 8 min. Easy. 1. Drain and flake tuna. 2. Drain and rinse beans. 3. Slice all vegetables, chop olives. 4. Whisk oil, vinegar, mustard, paprika, salt. 5. Combine everything in a bowl, toss with dressing. 6. Serve with baguette. - Swap 1: tuna → 180 g cooked chicken breast. - Swap 2: cannellini → 150 g chickpeas. - Coach: tuna in

water, not oil. Adds ~80 kcal per can otherwise for no flavor gain.

8P — Apple, Skyr, Cinnamon | 280 kcal · P 28 · C 35 · F 3 - 200 g 0% skyr, 1 medium apple (180 g), 5 g honey, 1 g cinnamon. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Dice apple. 2. Top skyr with apple, honey, cinnamon. - Swap 1: apple → 1 pear. - Swap 2: skyr → 200 g 0% Greek yogurt.

8D — Paella-Style Chicken & Shrimp Skillet | 620 kcal · P 60 · C 70 · F 12 - 120 g chicken breast, 120 g shrimp, 70 g bomba or short-grain rice (dry), 350 ml chicken stock, 0.2 g saffron, 80 g onion, 100 g bell pepper, 100 g tomato, 8 g garlic, 5 g smoked paprika, 5 g sweet paprika, 80 g peas (frozen), 10 ml olive oil, 10 g parsley, 15 ml lemon, 1.5 g salt. - Cook time: 35 min. Medium. 1. Steep saffron in 50 ml warm stock. 2. Sear chicken in oil in a wide pan 3 min per side; remove. 3. Sauté onion, pepper 5 min; add garlic, paprikas 30 sec. 4. Grate tomato (squeeze flesh, discard skin) into pan; cook 3 min. 5. Add rice, toast 60 sec. 6. Pour in stock + saffron, salt; bring to a boil. 7. Nestle chicken back; simmer uncovered 15 min, no stirring. 8. Add shrimp and peas in the last 5 min. 9. Off heat, cover with foil, rest 5 min. 10. Finish with parsley and lemon. - Swap 1: shrimp → 150 g squid rings. - Swap 2: chicken → 150 g rabbit (classic) or 150 g pork loin. - Coach: the socarrat — the crispy rice crust at the bottom — is the signature. Crank heat the last 60 sec and listen for crackling. Don't stir.

Day 9 (Conditioning Z2 + Lower touch-up) — Asian (Thai)

9B — Thai-Style Chicken Congee | 410 kcal · P 38 · C 50 · F 8 - 50 g jasmine rice (dry), 150 g chicken breast (shredded), 600 ml chicken stock, 10 g ginger, 8 g garlic, 1 spring onion, 1 boiled egg, 10 ml fish sauce, 5 ml soy sauce, 5 ml sesame oil, 5 g cilantro, 1 lime, 5 g chili crisp (optional, ~30 kcal), 1 g white pepper. - Cook time: 30 min. Easy. 1. Simmer rice in stock with smashed ginger and garlic, 25 min until porridge consistency. 2. Stir in shredded cooked chicken (poach in the broth at start if raw). 3. Season with fish sauce, soy, white pepper. 4. Ladle into bowls. 5. Top with halved boiled egg, spring onion, cilantro, sesame oil, lime, chili crisp. - Swap 1: chicken → 150 g lean pork. - Swap 2: jasmine rice → 60 g pearl barley (longer cook). - Coach: congee is the most underrated breakfast in a deficit. 600 ml of broth equals 60 minutes of fullness.

9L — Vietnamese Bun Bo (Beef Vermicelli Bowl) | 600 kcal · P 50 · C 65 · F 15 - 180 g 95% lean beef (sirloin or flank, sliced thin), 80 g rice vermicelli (dry), 150 g shredded carrot, 100 g cucumber, 80 g bean sprouts, 30 g mint, 30 g cilantro, 30 g Thai basil, 50 g romaine, 30 g pickled daikon, 30 g crushed peanuts, 20 ml fish sauce, 20 ml lime juice, 10 g sugar, 5 g garlic, 3 g chili, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g soy sauce. - Cook time: 18 min. Medium. 1. Soak vermicelli in hot water 6 min, drain, cool. 2. Marinate beef with soy, sugar (5 g), garlic, sesame oil 5 min. 3. Whisk nuoc cham: fish sauce, lime, remaining sugar, garlic, chili, 30 ml water. 4. Sear beef in a smoking-hot pan 2 min, just to char. 5. Build bowl: vermicelli, lettuce, herbs, carrot, cucumber, sprouts. 6. Top with beef, pickled daikon, peanuts. 7. Pour nuoc cham across. - Swap 1: beef → 180 g grilled chicken thigh (skinless). - Swap 2: vermicelli → 200 g shirataki noodles (drops carbs — increase rice at dinner). - Coach: nuoc cham — fish sauce + lime + sugar + chili — is the master Vietnamese dressing. Memorize the 3:3:2:1 ratio.

9P — Pineapple, Cottage Cheese, Honey | 270 kcal · P 28 · C 32 · F 3 - 200 g 2% cottage cheese, 150 g pineapple, 5 g honey, 3 g mint. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy. 1. Dice pineapple. 2. Top cottage cheese with pineapple, honey, mint.

9D — Thai Basil Chicken (Pad Krapow) with Egg & Rice | 650 kcal · P 60 · C 60 · F 18 - 200 g 96% lean ground chicken, 150 g cooked jasmine rice (50 g dry), 80 g green beans, 60 g bell pepper, 30 g Thai basil, 1 egg, 10 g garlic, 4 g Thai bird chili, 10 ml fish sauce, 8 ml oyster sauce, 5 ml soy sauce, 5 g sugar, 8 ml neutral oil, 1 g salt. - Cook time: 14 min. Medium. 1. Cook rice 12 min covered. 2. Pound garlic and chili in a mortar (or finely chop). 3. Heat oil in a wok screaming hot; add garlic-chili paste 20 sec. 4. Add ground chicken; break up, sear 4 min. 5. Add green beans and pepper, stir-fry 2 min. 6. Pour in fish, oyster, soy sauces and sugar; toss. 7. Off heat, fold in Thai basil until just wilted.

8. Fry egg in remaining oil, runny yolk. 9. Plate rice, chicken, egg on top. - Swap 1: ground chicken → 200 g lean ground turkey. - Swap 2: green beans → 100 g broccoli. - Coach: real Thai basil, not Italian. Italian basil tastes like sweet pasta sauce in this dish — it kills it. Asian grocery, fresh, 30 g.

Day 10 (Pull) — American (Smokehouse-Light)

10B — High-Protein Pancakes with Banana | 460 kcal · P 42 · C 55 · F 6 - 50 g oats, 40 g whey isolate, 200 g egg whites, 1 banana, 80 g blueberries, 5 g baking powder, 5 g cinnamon, 5 g vanilla, 1 g salt, cooking spray, 15 g maple syrup. - Cook time: 12 min. Easy. 1. Blend oats, whey, whites, half the banana, baking powder, cinnamon, vanilla, salt. 2. Cook pancakes 90 sec per side in non-stick (spray), makes ~5. 3. Slice remaining banana. 4. Stack, top with banana and blueberries, drizzle syrup. - Swap 1: maple syrup → 15 g honey. - Swap 2: blueberries → 100 g raspberries.

10L — Smoked Turkey Burger, Slaw, Sweet Potato Wedges | 600 kcal · P 55 · C 55 · F 16 - 180 g 93% lean ground turkey, 50 g whole wheat bun (or 60 g whole wheat roll), 150 g sweet potato (cut into wedges), 100 g cabbage, 50 g carrot, 30 g red onion, 30 g mustard, 15 g BBQ sauce (low-sugar), 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 20 ml apple cider vinegar, 5 g paprika, 5 g garlic powder, 5 g onion powder, 5 g brown sugar, 5 ml olive oil, 1.5 g salt, 1 g pepper. - Cook time: 30 min. Medium. 1. Heat oven to 220°C / 425°F. 2. Toss sweet potato wedges with oil, salt, half the paprika; roast 25 min, flip at 14. 3. Mix turkey with garlic powder, onion powder, remaining paprika, salt, pepper, brown sugar; form 1 patty. 4. Sear patty in a hot dry pan 4 min per side until 74°C / 165°F internal. 5. Shred cabbage and carrot; toss with yogurt, vinegar, salt, pepper. 6. Toast bun. 7. Build: bun, mustard, BBQ, patty, slaw, top bun. Wedges on the side. - Swap 1: turkey → 180 g 95% lean ground beef. - Swap 2: bun → 80 g sourdough (open-faced). - Coach: yogurt-based slaw replaces the 300 kcal of mayo slaw. Vinegar and salt do the work.

10P — Whey, Banana, Espresso Shake | 310 kcal · P 32 · C 38 · F 4 - 30 g whey isolate, 1 banana, 60 g 0% Greek yogurt, 30 ml espresso, 200 ml water, ice, 5 g cocoa powder. - Cook time: 2 min. Easy. 1. Blend everything 30 sec. - Swap 1: espresso → 30 ml strong coffee. - Swap 2: cocoa → 5 g cinnamon. - Coach: 90 min before pulling weights, caffeine helps. Time it.

10D — Pulled Chicken with Coleslaw and Black Beans | 590 kcal · P 60 · C 55 · F 12 - 220 g chicken breast, 100 g black beans (canned), 150 g coleslaw mix, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 20 ml apple cider vinegar, 20 g BBQ sauce (low-sugar), 5 g smoked paprika, 5 g garlic powder, 5 g onion powder, 2 g cumin, 1 g cayenne, 200 g corn on the cob (1 cob), 5 ml olive oil, 1.5 g salt, 1 g pepper, 15 g chives. - Cook time: 28 min. Medium. 1. Heat oven to 180°C / 360°F. 2. Rub chicken with paprika, garlic, onion, cumin, cayenne, salt, pepper. 3. Sear 2 min per side, then bake 16 min until 74°C / 165°F internal. 4. Rest 5 min; shred with two forks, toss with BBQ sauce. 5. Boil corn 6 min, brush with oil and salt. 6. Toss slaw mix with yogurt, vinegar, salt. 7. Warm black beans with a pinch of cumin. 8. Plate, scatter chives. - Swap 1: chicken → 200 g lean pork loin, shredded. - Swap 2: corn → 150 g baby potatoes roasted. - Coach: real BBQ uses cheap, sugary sauces. Pick one under 8 g sugar per 30 g.

Day 11 (Push) — Japanese

11B — Tamagoyaki & Brown Rice Bowl | 420 kcal · P 36 · C 50 · F 8 - 3 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 120 g cooked brown rice (40 g dry), 80 g spinach, 5 g soy sauce, 5 g mirin, 5 g rice vinegar, 5 ml neutral oil, 5 g sesame seeds, 80 g cucumber, 50 g pickled radish, 1 nori sheet. - Cook time: 12 min. Medium. 1. Whisk eggs + whites with soy, mirin, vinegar. 2. Heat oil in a square pan; pour in 1/3 egg, roll when set, push to one side. 3. Repeat with two more layers, building a rolled omelette. 4. Wilt spinach in the empty pan 60 sec. 5. Plate rice; slice tamago into 2 cm pieces; lay on rice. 6. Top with spinach, cucumber, pickled radish, sesame, crumbled nori. - Swap 1: eggs → 4 whole eggs (skip the

whites, raise fat by 8 g). - Swap 2: brown rice → 120 g cooked white sushi rice. - Coach: tamagoyaki is a knife-skill flex but practice once and you have a beautiful protein in 6 min.

11L — Salmon Poke Bowl | 600 kcal · P 50 · C 55 · F 18 - 170 g sashimi-grade salmon, 150 g cooked sushi rice (50 g dry), 80 g cucumber, 80 g shredded carrot, 60 g edamame (shelled), 60 g avocado, 40 g red cabbage, 1 nori sheet, 15 ml soy sauce, 10 ml rice vinegar, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g ginger (grated), 5 g sugar, 5 g sriracha, 10 g sesame seeds, 1 spring onion. - Cook time: 12 min. Easy. 1. Cube salmon into 1.5 cm pieces. 2. Whisk soy, vinegar, sesame oil, ginger, sugar. 3. Marinate salmon in half the sauce 5 min. 4. Cook rice in advance, fan to room temp, season with remaining vinegar and a pinch of salt. 5. Build bowl: rice base, salmon, vegetables, edamame in zones. 6. Drizzle remaining sauce + sriracha, top with sesame, spring onion, crumbled nori. - Swap 1: salmon → 170 g sashimi-grade tuna. - Swap 2: avocado → 80 g cucumber (lower fat by 12 g). - Coach: sashimi-grade or don't bother. Costco or a real fishmonger.

11P — Edamame & Skyr | 280 kcal · P 30 · C 26 · F 6 - 200 g 0% skyr, 100 g shelled edamame, 5 g honey, 2 g flaky salt, 1 g chili flakes. - Cook time: 5 min. Easy. 1. Boil edamame in salted water 4 min. 2. Toss with flaky salt and chili. 3. Drizzle honey on skyr. 4. Eat side by side.

11D — Chicken Katsu, Steamed Greens, Rice | 620 kcal · P 60 · C 62 · F 14 - 200 g chicken breast, 150 g cooked rice (50 g dry), 200 g bok choy, 30 g panko, 1 egg white, 10 g flour, 8 g tonkatsu sauce, 10 g Kewpie-style low-fat mayo, 5 ml neutral oil, 10 g ginger, 5 g garlic, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g soy sauce, 1 g salt, 5 g sesame seeds, 1 spring onion. - Cook time: 22 min. Medium. 1. Pound chicken to 1.5 cm. Salt. 2. Dredge: flour → egg white → panko, pressing crumbs in. 3. Pan-fry in 5 ml oil over medium-high, 4 min per side, 73°C / 165°F internal. 4. Steam bok choy 4 min; toss with ginger, garlic, sesame oil, soy. 5. Slice katsu into 2 cm strips. 6. Plate rice, katsu, greens. 7. Drizzle tonkatsu and mayo. Garnish with sesame, spring onion. - Swap 1: chicken → 200 g lean pork loin (proper katsu). - Swap 2: panko → 30 g crushed cornflakes. - Coach: real katsu is deep-fried in 1 L of oil. Pan-fry with 5 ml is 80% of the experience at a third of the calories.

Day 12 (Pull — REFEED day, starting Week 5) — Indian / Pakistani

Macro target today: 2775 kcal / P 175 / C 360 / F 48.

12B — Paratha & Chana Masala | 700 kcal · P 38 · C 110 · F 12 - 1 whole wheat paratha (80 g, find a low-fat brand or make), 250 g chickpeas (canned), 150 g tomato, 80 g onion, 8 g ginger, 8 g garlic, 5 ml ghee, 3 g cumin seeds, 5 g chana masala spice blend, 1 g turmeric, 2 g chili powder, 1 green chili, 5 g cilantro, 10 ml lemon, 1.5 g salt, 100 g 0% Greek yogurt. - Cook time: 22 min. Medium. 1. Heat ghee, sizzle cumin seeds 30 sec. 2. Add onion, ginger, garlic, chili; sauté 4 min. 3. Add tomato (chopped), turmeric, chili powder, chana masala; cook 6 min until oil separates. 4. Add chickpeas with 150 ml water, simmer 8 min. 5. Mash some chickpeas against the pot for body. 6. Finish with lemon, cilantro, salt. 7. Heat paratha in a dry pan 90 sec per side. 8. Serve with cold yogurt. - Swap 1: chana masala blend → garam masala 3 g + amchur 2 g. - Swap 2: paratha → 2 whole wheat rotis (80 g). - Coach: refeed breakfast loaded with complex carbs. The chickpeas double as fiber + protein.

12L — Chicken Biryani (Light) | 800 kcal · P 60 · C 110 · F 18 - 180 g chicken breast (or thigh trimmed), 110 g basmati rice (dry), 80 g onion, 80 g tomato, 100 g 0% Greek yogurt (marinade), 10 g ginger, 10 g garlic, 1 green chili, 1 g saffron in 30 ml warm milk, 8 g biryani masala (or garam masala 4 g + coriander 2 g + cumin 1 g + cardamom 1 g), 5 ml ghee, 1 cinnamon stick, 3 cardamom pods, 3 cloves, 1 bay leaf, 15 g mint, 15 g cilantro, 30 g fried onion (store-bought OK), 10 ml lemon, 2 g salt. - Cook time: 50 min. Hard. 1. Marinate chicken in yogurt, half the ginger/garlic, biryani masala, chili, lemon, 1 g salt, 15 min. 2. Soak rice 20 min, drain. 3. In a pot, parboil rice in 1.5 L water with whole spices and 1 g salt, 6 min; drain. 4. In the same pot, cook chicken with marinade 12 min. 5. Layer half the rice over chicken, sprinkle half the mint, cilantro, fried onion, saffron milk. 6. Top with remaining rice and the rest of

toppings. 7. Cover with foil + lid, dum-cook on lowest heat 18 min. 8. Rest 5 min. Fluff gently. - Swap 1: chicken → 180 g shrimp (cook 6 min total at end). - Swap 2: basmati → 110 g brown basmati (longer cook). - Coach: this is your refeed lunch — a 110 g dry rice serving is huge but legal today. Treat it as fuel for tomorrow's Push.

12P — Mango, Rice Cakes, Whey | 320 kcal · P 30 · C 50 · F 3 - 150 g mango, 3 rice cakes (27 g), 30 g whey isolate, 5 g honey, 1 g cardamom. - Cook time: 2 min. Easy. 1. Shake whey in 300 ml water with cardamom. 2. Drizzle rice cakes with honey. 3. Eat mango on the side.

12D — Tandoori Chicken with Jeera Rice & Saag | 950 kcal · P 50 · C 90 · F 22 - 200 g chicken breast, 100 g basmati rice (dry), 250 g spinach, 100 g tomato, 80 g onion, 8 g ginger, 8 g garlic, 5 ml ghee, 5 ml mustard oil, 4 g cumin seeds, 5 g tandoori masala, 2 g garam masala, 1 g turmeric, 50 g 0% Greek yogurt (marinade), 10 ml lemon, 10 g cilantro, 1.5 g salt, 20 g cashew (refeed flex). - Cook time: 32 min. Medium. 1. Marinate chicken in yogurt, tandoori masala, half the ginger/garlic, lemon, 1 g salt; 15 min minimum. 2. Cook rice with cumin seeds and 5 g ghee, 12 min covered, rest 5. 3. Broil chicken 6 min per side, 73°C / 165°F internal. 4. Blanch spinach 60 sec, ice, blend rough. 5. Heat mustard oil till smoking, then cool slightly; add remaining ginger/garlic, onion; cook 4 min. 6. Add tomato, turmeric, garam masala; cook 4 min. 7. Stir in spinach purée; simmer 4 min; add 50 ml water. 8. Plate rice, chicken, saag; scatter cashews and cilantro. - Swap 1: chicken → 200 g paneer (refeed only — drop other meals' fat). - Swap 2: spinach → 250 g mustard greens (saag sarson). - Coach: refeed dinner. Eat it. Sleep 8 hours. The scale may bump up 0.5–1 kg tomorrow from glycogen + sodium — that is water, not fat. Hold the line.

Day 13 (Conditioning intervals + Lower touch-up) — Mexican

13B — Black Bean & Egg Burrito | 480 kcal · P 38 · C 50 · F 14 - 1 whole wheat tortilla (60 g), 2 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 100 g black beans, 60 g salsa, 30 g 2% cottage cheese, 30 g red bell pepper, 30 g onion, 5 ml olive oil, 5 g taco spice (recipe §5.4), 10 g cilantro. - Cook time: 10 min. Easy. 1. Sauté pepper and onion in oil 3 min. 2. Scramble eggs + whites with taco spice, 2 min. 3. Warm beans, warm tortilla. 4. Build burrito: beans, eggs, salsa, cottage cheese, cilantro. 5. Roll tight. - Swap 1: tortilla → 2 corn tortillas (60 g). - Swap 2: cottage cheese → 30 g shredded part-skim mozzarella.

13L — Carne Asada Salad | 580 kcal · P 55 · C 35 · F 22 - 180 g flank steak, 200 g romaine, 100 g cherry tomato, 60 g red onion, 80 g avocado, 80 g black beans, 40 g pickled jalapeños, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 15 ml lime, 5 g chipotle powder, 5 g cumin, 5 g garlic powder, 5 g oregano, 5 ml olive oil, 1.5 g salt, 10 g cilantro. - Cook time: 18 min. Medium. 1. Marinate steak in lime, chipotle, cumin, garlic, oregano, oil, salt, 10 min. 2. Sear in a screaming-hot pan 3 min per side; rest 5 min, slice thin against the grain. 3. Chop salad components. 4. Thin yogurt with lime for crema. 5. Build salad; lay steak on top. 6. Drizzle crema, scatter cilantro. - Swap 1: flank → 180 g skirt steak. - Swap 2: avocado → 30 g pumpkin seeds (lower fat per portion). - Coach: flank against the grain or it eats like rubber.

13P — Whey + Apple + Almonds | 320 kcal · P 32 · C 32 · F 8 - 30 g whey isolate, 1 apple, 12 g almonds. - Cook time: 1 min. Easy.

13D — Fish Tacos with Cabbage Slaw | 540 kcal · P 50 · C 50 · F 14 - 200 g cod or tilapia, 2 corn tortillas (60 g), 150 g cabbage, 60 g carrot, 60 g red onion, 30 g 0% Greek yogurt, 30 g salsa verde, 15 g chipotle in adobo (1 pepper minced + sauce), 10 g cilantro, 15 ml lime, 5 ml olive oil, 5 g cumin, 5 g paprika, 5 g garlic powder, 1.5 g salt. - Cook time: 15 min. Easy. 1. Rub fish with cumin, paprika, garlic, salt. 2. Pan-sear in oil 3 min per side until flaking, 60°C / 140°F internal. 3. Shred cabbage and carrot; toss with yogurt, lime, salt. 4. Mix yogurt with minced chipotle for hot crema. 5. Warm tortillas in a dry pan. 6. Flake fish into tortillas; top with slaw, hot crema, salsa verde, cilantro. - Swap 1: fish → 200 g shrimp. - Swap 2: corn tortillas → 1 large whole wheat tortilla (60 g). - Coach: undercook the fish slightly — it carries over.

Day 14 (REST DAY) — Italian (lower carb)

Macro target today: 2100 kcal / P 195 / C 115 / F 73. Walk. Stretch. Eat slow.

14B — Italian Soft Scramble with Prosciutto & Tomato | 430 kcal · P 38 · C 15 · F 24 - 3 whole eggs + 80 g egg whites, 30 g prosciutto, 100 g cherry tomato, 80 g arugula, 30 g low-fat ricotta, 5 g chives, 5 ml olive oil, 1 g salt, 1 g pepper, 50 g sourdough. - Cook time: 8 min. Easy. 1. Whisk eggs + whites with salt and pepper. 2. Cook in non-stick pan over low heat, stirring constantly with rubber spatula, 3 min — soft curds. 3. Off heat, fold in ricotta. 4. Toast sourdough, rub with halved tomato. 5. Plate eggs on toast, drape prosciutto, scatter arugula and chives, drizzle oil. - Swap 1: prosciutto → 60 g smoked turkey breast. - Swap 2: ricotta → 30 g goat cheese.

14L — Tuscan White Bean & Tuna Salad | 540 kcal · P 50 · C 35 · F 22 - 150 g tuna in water (drained), 150 g cannellini beans, 200 g cherry tomato, 100 g cucumber, 60 g red onion, 30 g olives, 60 g avocado, 200 g romaine, 12 ml olive oil, 15 ml red wine vinegar, 5 g Dijon, 5 g oregano, 1 g salt, 10 g basil, 1 g chili flakes. - Cook time: 8 min. Easy. 1. Drain tuna; rinse beans. 2. Slice all vegetables. 3. Whisk oil, vinegar, mustard, oregano, salt, chili. 4. Toss everything in a large bowl. 5. Top with torn basil.

14P — Cottage Cheese & Pear | 230 kcal · P 28 · C 22 · F 4 - 200 g 2% cottage cheese, 1 pear, 1 g cinnamon, 5 g honey.

14D — Osso Bucco-Style Braised Pork with Polenta | 900 kcal · P 79 · C 43 · F 23 - 220 g lean pork loin or 200 g lean braising beef (chuck trimmed), 40 g polenta (dry), 200 ml chicken stock, 200 ml beef stock, 100 g carrot, 80 g celery, 80 g onion, 200 g tomato (canned crushed), 8 g garlic, 5 g rosemary, 5 g thyme, 1 bay leaf, 100 ml red wine, 15 ml olive oil, 20 g parmesan, 10 g parsley, 5 g lemon zest, 1.5 g salt, 1 g pepper. - Cook time: 90 min (mostly hands-off). Medium. 1. Heat oven to 160°C / 320°F. 2. Salt meat, sear in oil in a Dutch oven 3 min per side; remove. 3. Sauté carrot, celery, onion 6 min. 4. Add garlic, herbs, 30 sec. 5. Deglaze with wine, reduce 2 min. 6. Add tomato, stocks, bay leaf; return meat. 7. Cover, braise 70 min until fork-tender. 8. In last 15 min, cook polenta with 250 ml water + stock, 12 min, stir in parmesan. 9. Slice meat, ladle sauce, plate over polenta. 10. Finish with parsley and lemon zest gremolata. - Swap 1: braising beef → 220 g pork tenderloin (cook 25 min only). - Swap 2: polenta → 80 g mashed cauliflower (drops carbs further). - Coach: rest day, end of plan. The braise is reward — high protein, modest fat, structured carbs. Cook it once, eat half tomorrow.

3. Master Grocery Lists

Quantities calibrated for 80 kg reference, single eater. Scale ±20% for tier.

3.1 Week 1 (Days 1–7)

Proteins - Chicken breast: 1.4 kg - Cod or whitefish: 400 g - Salmon fillet: 350 g - Shrimp: 400 g - 95% lean ground beef: 200 g - 90% lean ground lamb (or beef): 200 g - Eggs: 18 large - Egg whites (carton): 750 g - 2% cottage cheese: 700 g - 0% Greek yogurt: 800 g - 0% skyr: 200 g - Low-fat feta: 60 g - Smoked salmon: 60 g - Whey isolate: 90 g (3 scoops) - Lean bacon: 50 g - 1 boiled egg from existing supply or extra

Carbs - Sourdough: 1 loaf (160 g used) - Whole wheat roti or pita: 4 pieces - Corn tortillas: 4 - Rolled oats: 200 g - Basmati rice: 50 g dry (Day 1 + buffer) - Jasmine rice: 50 g dry (Day 2) - Brown rice: 80 g dry - White rice: 80 g dry - Baby potatoes: 200 g - Sweet potato: 200 g - Bulgur: 60 g dry - Rice cakes: 6 - Rye crackers: 4 - Banana: 4 - Apple: 2 - Pineapple: 270 g - Pear or backup fruit: 2 - Blueberries: 280 g (Day 5 refeed heavy) - Raspberries: 100 g

Fats - Extra-virgin olive oil: 80 ml - Ghee: 10 g - Butter: 25 g - Tahini (for hummus): 30 g - Avocado: 1 (Day 7 + 8) - Almonds: 24 g (Day 1 + 13) - Pistachios: 10 g - Walnuts: 20 g

Vegetables (target 600 g/day floor across all meals) - Broccoli: 800 g - Spinach: 400 g - Bell peppers (mixed): 600 g - Onion (yellow + red): 700 g - Tomato (fresh + cherry): 800 g - Canned San Marzano tomatoes: 300 g - Canned crushed tomatoes: 400 g - Cucumber: 600 g - Romaine: 700 g - Red cabbage: 100 g - Eggplant: 200 g - Zucchini: 200 g - Cauliflower: 250 g - Carrot: 300 g - Asparagus: 200 g - Frozen peas: 80 g - Edamame (shelled): 150 g - Bean sprouts: 80 g - Mushrooms: 200 g (optional swap) - Garlic: 1 bulb - Ginger: 50 g - Lemon: 5 - Lime: 3 - Fresh parsley: 80 g - Fresh cilantro: 60 g - Fresh basil: 20 g - Fresh mint: 20 g - Fresh dill: 5 g

Pantry & Spices - Soy sauce - Fish sauce - Sesame oil - Sesame seeds - Rice vinegar - Balsamic vinegar - Red wine vinegar - Capers - Olives (pitted) - Pickled turnip - Kimchi: 200 g - Gochujang - Mirin - White miso - Saffron: 0.5 g total - Vanilla extract - Honey: 100 g - Maple syrup: small - Hot sauce (Cholula, Frank's) - Mustard (Dijon + yellow) - BBQ sauce (low-sugar) - Tonkatsu sauce (optional) - Chickpeas: 1 can - Black beans: 1 can - Cannellini beans: 1 can - Lentils (red, dry): 60 g - Chicken stock: 1 L - Beef stock: 250 ml - Panko: 30 g

Spices: shawarma blend, taco blend, garam masala, biryani masala, tandoori masala, smoked paprika, sweet paprika, cumin (whole + ground), coriander (ground), turmeric, sumac, cinnamon, cardamom (pods + ground), chili flakes, cayenne, oregano, thyme, rosemary, bay leaf, mustard seeds, salt (fine + flaky), black pepper.

Dairy - Low-fat ricotta: 30 g (Week 2) - Parmesan: 50 g - Blue cheese: 30 g

Optional - Diet soda - Sparkling water - Black coffee - Green tea - Sugar-free gum

Week 1 cost band (USD): - Low: \$95 (generic supermarket, cheaper proteins, frozen vegetables) - Medium: \$135 (Trader Joe's / mainstream, fresh produce) - High: \$185 (Whole Foods, line-caught fish, grass-fed, organic produce)

3.2 Week 2 (Days 8–14)

Proteins - Chicken breast: 1.5 kg - 96% lean ground chicken: 200 g - 93% lean ground turkey: 180 g - Lean pork loin or pork tenderloin: 220 g - Lean rib-eye cap or sirloin: 200 g (carryover from W1 if not used) - Flank steak: 180 g - Salmon (sashimi grade): 170 g - Cod or tilapia: 200 g - Tuna in water: 2 cans (300 g) - Shrimp: 120 g (or carryover) - Prosciutto: 30 g - Lean braising meat: 220 g (Day 14) - Eggs: 18 - Egg whites (carton): 700 g - 2% cottage cheese: 600 g - 0% Greek yogurt: 700 g - 0% skyr: 400 g - Low-fat feta: 60 g - Low-fat ricotta: 30 g - Whey isolate: 120 g - Smoked turkey (optional swap): 60 g

Carbs - Whole wheat tortilla: 1 large - Corn tortillas: 4 - Whole wheat paratha: 1 - Whole wheat bun: 1 - Sourdough: leftover from W1 - Baguette: 60 g - Rolled oats: 50 g - Basmati rice (refeed-heavy): 230 g dry - Sushi rice: 100 g dry - Brown rice: 40 g dry - Bomba or short-grain rice: 70 g dry - Jasmine rice: 50 g dry - White rice: 50 g dry - Rice vermicelli: 80 g - Rice cakes: 7 - Polenta: 40 g - Sweet potato: 150 g - Corn on the cob: 1 - Banana: 4 - Apple: 2 - Pear: 1 - Pineapple: 150 g - Mango: 300 g (1.5 mango or frozen) - Blueberries: 280 g (refeed) - Raspberries: 100 g - Strawberries: 100 g - Cherries (optional): 100 g

Fats - Olive oil: 80 ml - Ghee: 10 g - Mustard oil: 10 ml - Butter: 20 g - Avocado: 2 (Day 11 + 14) - Crushed peanuts: 30 g - Cashews: 20 g (refeed) - Pumpkin seeds: 30 g (optional)

Vegetables - Broccoli + broccolini: 750 g - Bok choy: 300 g - Spinach: 500 g - Tenderstem broccoli (optional swap) - Cabbage (green): 300 g - Red cabbage: 100 g - Bell peppers: 500 g - Onion: 700 g - Tomato + cherry: 700 g - Canned crushed tomatoes: 400 g - Cucumber: 550 g - Romaine + arugula: 700 g - Carrot: 400 g - Celery: 80 g - Green beans: 80 g - Bean sprouts: 80 g - Edamame: 220 g - Pickled radish: 50 g - Pickled jalapeños: 100 g - Pickled daikon: 30 g - Coleslaw mix: 150 g - Roasted red peppers (jar): 200 g - Frozen peas: 80 g - Mushrooms: 200 g (optional) - Garlic: 1 bulb - Ginger: 60 g - Lemon: 5 - Lime: 5 - Fresh cilantro: 80 g - Fresh parsley: 60 g - Fresh basil + Thai basil: 50 g -

Fresh mint: 30 g - Chives: 20 g

Pantry & Spices - Continued from Week 1. - Add: sriracha, chipotle in adobo (small can), salsa verde, tonkatsu sauce, low-fat Kewpie-style mayo, oyster sauce, fried onions (small bag), Thai bird chili, nori sheets (3), nuoc cham (or assemble from fish sauce + lime + sugar), curry leaves (optional), saffron threads (carryover), red wine (100 ml for braise).

Dairy (continued) **Optional** (same as W1)

Week 2 cost band (USD): - Low: \$105 (a touch higher due to sashimi salmon and braising meat) - Medium: \$145 - High: \$200

4. Meal-Swap Matrix

All swaps within ± 40 kcal, ± 5 g protein. Match by slot.

4.1 Breakfast swaps (B)

Original (kcal/P/C/F)	Swap candidates
Smoked Salmon Cottage Cheese Toast (430/42/38/12)	Mediterranean Egg Toast (440/38/40/14); Italian Soft Scramble (430/38/15/24 — rest day); Tamago Oats (470/38/50/12 — Asian)
Shakshuka with Feta (430/36/28/18)	Huevos Rancheros (440/38/42/14); Masala Egg White Scramble (420/40/42/10); Tamagoyaki Bowl (420/36/50/8)
Banana Pancakes (refeed 600)	Paratha & Chana Masala (700/38/110/12 — refeed); High-Protein Pancakes (460 — non-refeed swap, drop oats)
Spinach Feta Omelette (rest 460)	Italian Soft Scramble (430/38/15/24); Cobb breakfast (use lunch components)

4.2 Lunch swaps (L)

Original	Swap candidates
Chicken Shawarma Bowl (580/55/55/16)	Chicken Burrito Bowl (600/55/65/12); Chicken Tikka Salad (540/55/35/18); Korean Beef Bowl (600/52/58/16); Lamb Kofta Tabbouleh (580/50/50/18); Spanish Tuna Bean Salad (560/50/50/14); Vietnamese Bun Bo (600/50/65/15)
Smoked Turkey Burger (600)	Pulled Chicken with Slaw (590); Carne Asada Salad (580 with 22 g fat — recalibrate other meals); Salmon Poke (600)
Spaghetti Pomodoro (refeed 750)	Chicken Biryani (refeed 800); Risotto Milanese (refeed 1100, dinner-tier)

4.3 Pre-workout swaps (P) — all ~280–320 kcal, fat <8 g

- Apple + Whey + Almonds (320) ↔ Cottage Cheese + Pineapple + Crackers (290) ↔ Banana + Whey + Rice Cakes (330) ↔ Mango Lassi Shake (310) ↔ Whey + Banana Espresso Shake (310) ↔ Greek Yogurt + Honey + Pistachios (280) ↔ Pineapple + Cottage Cheese (270) ↔ Edamame + Skyr (280) ↔ Apple + Skyr + Cinnamon (280)

Rule: pre-Push or pre-Pull, prioritize the higher-carb options (rice cakes, banana, mango). Pre-conditioning or rest day, prioritize the protein-only options (yogurt, skyr, cottage cheese).

4.4 Dinner swaps (D)

Original	Swap candidates
Sheet-Pan Cod & Greens (480/48/38/14)	Fish Tacos (540/50/50/14); Miso Salmon (600/48/50/22); Falafel-Spiced Chicken (590/55/52/16)
Shrimp Fajita Skillet (510/48/48/14)	Pad Krapow (650/60/60/18); Chicken Katsu (620/60/62/14); Pulled Chicken (590/60/55/12)
Dal Tadka Combo (600)	Paella (620); Salmon Poke (600 — lunch-grade)
Rib-Eye Rest-Day Dinner (840)	Osso Bucco Polenta (900) — rest-day calibrated
Risotto Milanese (refeed 1100)	Tandoori Chicken with Saag (refeed 950)

5. Cooking Primer

5.1 Sunday batch-cook playbook (90 min, sets up 4 days)

1. Roast 1 kg chicken breast — split, pound to even thickness, brine 30 min in 1 L water + 30 g salt + 20 g sugar, dry, season with paprika + garlic powder + salt, roast at 200°C / 400°F 20 min until 73°C / 165°F. Slice cold, store.
2. Cook rice base — 200 g jasmine + 200 g brown, separate pots, 12 min each, fan-cool spread on a tray.
3. Hard-boil 8 eggs — boil 9 min, ice bath, peel. Store unpeeled if possible.
4. Pre-cut vegetables — 400 g broccoli florets, 300 g bell pepper, 300 g cucumber, 300 g cherry tomatoes, 200 g red onion. Store in glass.
5. Make 2 master sauces — low-fat tzatziki (200 g) and chimichurri (150 g). Recipes §5.5.
6. Toast spice blends — make 2 weeks' worth of shawarma + taco blends in a dry pan 90 sec, jar.
7. Portion whey — pre-bag scoops for the week. Add measured almonds/walnuts to small zip bags.

5.2 Storage rules

Food	Fridge (4°C / 40°F)	Freezer
Cooked chicken breast	3 days	2 months
Cooked rice / grains	4 days	1 month

Food	Fridge (4°C / 40°F)	Freezer
Hard-boiled eggs (peeled)	5 days	Do not freeze
Cooked fish	2 days	1 month
Cooked ground meat	3 days	2 months
Cut vegetables (raw)	4 days	N/A
Greek yogurt / cottage cheese (opened)	7 days	N/A
Fresh herbs	5 days wrapped in damp paper	Chop, oil-cube, freeze 3 months
Hummus (homemade)	5 days	1 month
Tzatziki	4 days	Do not freeze
Chimichurri	7 days	3 months

Reheat rice with a wet paper towel over the bowl, microwave 90 sec — keeps it from drying out. Reheat lean meat in a pan with a splash of water + lid, low heat, 3 min; never microwave chicken breast unsupervised.

5.3 Knife and pan minimums

- 8-inch chef's knife (sharp; sharpen weekly with a ceramic rod).
- Wooden cutting board (large, real one).
- 12-inch cast iron skillet.
- 12-inch non-stick pan.
- Heavy sheet pan.
- Wok (carbon steel, \$30, pays for itself in week 2).
- Dutch oven (Day 14 braise).
- Digital meat thermometer. Non-negotiable. Chicken at 73°C / 165°F, fish at 60°C / 140°F, beef rare 50°C / 122°F, medium-rare 54°C / 130°F, medium 60°C / 140°F, ground meats at 71°C / 160°F.

5.4 Eight spice blends (exact ratios)

All measured by weight in grams.

1. Shawarma: cumin 4, coriander 3, paprika 3, turmeric 1, cinnamon 1, allspice 1, black pepper 1, cardamom 0.5, clove 0.5.
2. Taco / Tex-Mex: chili powder 5, cumin 3, paprika 2, garlic powder 2, onion powder 2, oregano 1, salt 1, cayenne 0.5.
3. Garam masala: cumin 4, coriander 4, cardamom 2, cinnamon 2, clove 1, black pepper 1, nutmeg 0.5, bay 0.5.
4. Italian herb blend: oregano 4, basil 4, thyme 2, rosemary 2, marjoram 1, garlic powder 1.
5. Cajun: paprika 5, garlic powder 3, onion powder 3, oregano 2, thyme 2, cayenne 2, black pepper 2, white pepper 1.

6. Jerk: allspice 4, thyme 3, garlic powder 2, onion powder 2, brown sugar 2, black pepper 2, cinnamon 1, nutmeg 1, scotch bonnet powder 1, salt 1.
7. Ras el hanout: cumin 3, coriander 3, ginger 2, cinnamon 2, paprika 2, turmeric 1, black pepper 1, allspice 1, cardamom 1, clove 0.5, nutmeg 0.5.
8. Herbes de Provence: thyme 4, oregano 3, savory 2, rosemary 2, marjoram 1, lavender 0.5 (real; not soap).

Toast all blends in a dry pan 60 sec before storing in airtight jars. Use 5–8 g per protein portion.

5.5 Five universal low-cal, high-flavor sauces

1. Low-fat tzatziki (per 200 g serve: 110 kcal, 14 P, 7 C, 3 F): 200 g 0% Greek yogurt, 80 g grated cucumber (salted, squeezed), 5 g garlic (microplaned), 10 ml lemon juice, 5 g dill, 1 g salt, 1 g white pepper. Stir. Rest 20 min for flavors.
2. Salsa verde (per 200 g: 80 kcal, 2 P, 18 C, 0 F): 300 g tomatillos roasted, 1 jalapeño, 30 g onion, 5 g garlic, 15 g cilantro, 15 ml lime juice, 2 g salt. Blend. Pourable.
3. Chimichurri (per 100 g: 200 kcal, 1 P, 4 C, 20 F): 80 g flat-leaf parsley, 20 g oregano, 8 g garlic, 50 ml olive oil, 20 ml red wine vinegar, 2 g chili flakes, 2 g salt. Pulse. Use 20 g per portion.
4. Mustard vinaigrette (per 100 ml: 380 kcal, 1 P, 4 C, 38 F): 30 ml olive oil, 30 ml red wine vinegar, 15 g Dijon, 10 g honey, 5 g garlic, 1 g salt, 1 g pepper. Whisk or shake in a jar. Use 15 g per salad.
5. Soy-ginger (per 100 ml: 90 kcal, 4 P, 14 C, 2 F): 40 ml soy sauce (low-sodium), 15 ml rice vinegar, 10 g grated ginger, 5 g garlic, 5 g honey, 5 g sesame oil, 5 g sesame seeds, 30 ml water. Whisk.

Make all five Sunday. They live 5–7 days and rescue any plain protein-and-vegetable plate.

6. Eating Out & Travel

6.1 Specific orders

Chipotle — Burrito bowl. Brown or white rice (half scoop). Black beans. Double chicken. Fajita vegetables. Mild + tomatillo green salsa. Lettuce. No cheese. No sour cream. No guac (or: yes guac, but skip the rice). Lime + Tabasco. Total: ~600 kcal, 60 g P, 60 g C, 14 g F.

Subway — 6" or footlong on whole wheat. Double turkey + ham (lean), or double chicken breast. Spinach, tomato, cucumber, onion, peppers, banana peppers, jalapeños, olives (light), pickles. Mustard + vinegar + black pepper + oregano. Skip mayo, ranch, chipotle sauce, cheese (or one slice provolone if you must). Footlong: ~650 kcal, 55 g P, 75 g C, 12 g F.

Nando's — Quarter chicken breast (extra hot or medium). Two sides: spicy rice + Macho Peas, or PERi-PERi chips (mind the portion) + corn on the cob. Skip garlic bread, halloumi, perinaise. ~600 kcal, 55 g P, 60 g C, 18 g F.

Kebab shop — Chicken shish (not doner). On a flatbread or wrap (skip if you can, ask for salad base). Loads of salad — lettuce, tomato, onion, cucumber, cabbage. Chili sauce + garlic yogurt (real yogurt, not garlic mayo). Skip rice + chips combo. ~650 kcal, 60 g P, 50 g C, 20 g F.

Sushi — Sashimi (12–15 pieces salmon/tuna/whitefish) + 1 nigiri set (6 pcs) + edamame + miso soup + seaweed salad. Skip tempura rolls, "crunchy" anything, spicy mayo, eel sauce. Soy + wasabi. ~620 kcal, 70 g P, 35 g C, 14 g F.

Mediterranean (Cava, Roti, local) — Power bowl. Saffron rice (half) or extra greens. Grilled chicken or falafel (chicken is leaner). Two cold dips: hummus + tzatziki. Tomato/cucumber/onion. Pickled vegetables. Skip feta. Lemon. ~600 kcal, 50 g P, 60 g C, 16 g F.

Italian (restaurant) — Grilled fish or chicken (no breading), side of vegetables, half portion of pasta or polenta. Skip bread basket (ask them not to bring it). Olive oil + vinegar + salt for dressing. One glass of wine = 130 kcal — eat into your fat budget for the day.

Steakhouse — 200 g sirloin or filet (lean cuts), double vegetable sides (steamed asparagus, sautéed spinach), small baked potato (skip butter, ask for salsa). Skip creamed spinach, mac and cheese, fries. One steak sauce, dipped. ~700 kcal, 65 g P, 40 g C, 25 g F.

Indian — Tandoori chicken, dal (not dal makhani — too much butter), saag (not saag paneer), one roti (not naan, not paratha), small raita. Skip korma, butter chicken, biryani-with-ghee. ~650 kcal, 60 g P, 55 g C, 18 g F.

6.2 Generic restaurant tactics

- Order first so the table doesn't influence you.
- Box half the plate before you start (restaurant portions are 1.5–2× home portions).
- Sauce on the side. Always.
- Bread basket: ask them to not bring it.
- Drink water + 1 club soda with lime between courses.
- "Grilled, not fried." "Steamed, not sautéed in butter." "Dressing on the side."

6.3 Travel and hotel fallbacks

- Hotel breakfast buffet: scrambled eggs (3) + extra egg whites + smoked salmon + fruit + black coffee + 1 slice of toast. Skip pastries, hash browns, sugary cereal.
- Gas station: beef jerky + string cheese + apple + bottled water. Or: rotisserie chicken (whole), eat the breast meat, ditch the skin.
- Airport: pre-pack 30 g whey scoops + 2 protein bars (Quest, Built, Barebells — sub-200 kcal, 20+ g P). Grilled chicken salad at most airport restaurants. Avoid creamy soups, anything labeled "loaded," and the croissant section.
- Hotel room with kettle only: oats + whey + boiling water + banana = 450 kcal, 30 g P. Buy at any grocery.
- AirBnB with kitchen: cook one Sheet Pan Cod (Day 1D) — it works in any oven and a single sheet pan.

7. Supplements

7.1 Tier 1 — actually worth it

1. Creatine monohydrate — 5 g/day, every day, in any drink. Single most evidence-backed legal performance supplement. Maintains strength and lean mass in a deficit. ~\$0.10/day. (Kreider et al. 2017, ISSN position stand.)
2. Whey protein isolate — 25–35 g/serve. Convenience tool for hitting 2.4 g/kg in a deficit, not a magic ingredient. Isolate over concentrate if lactose sensitive.

3. Vitamin D3 — 1000–2000 IU/day if sunlight is limited or 25-OH-D blood level is below 30 ng/mL. Get a blood test, then dose.
4. Omega-3 (EPA+DHA) — 1–2 g combined EPA+DHA from fish oil, if you don't eat 2 fatty fish meals/week. Look at the EPA+DHA on the back of the bottle, not the "fish oil" headline number.
5. Caffeine — 3–6 mg/kg pre-training. Coffee, espresso, pill, pre-workout — same molecule. Last dose at least 8 hours before bed.

7.2 Tier 2 — situational

- Caffeine for hunger — late-morning espresso when lunch is 2 hours away kills the urge to snack. 50–100 mg.
- Psyllium husk fiber — 5–10 g in water with meals when meal fiber is below 8 g. Helps satiety, glucose response, regularity.
- Electrolyte mix — sodium 1000 mg + potassium 400 mg + magnesium 100 mg in 500 ml water on conditioning days or whenever you feel flat. LMNT, Liquid IV (sugar-free), or DIY (salt + lite salt + 100 ml fruit juice).
- Ashwagandha (KSM-66) — 600 mg/day. Modest cortisol-blunting effect in stressed populations; may help with sleep. Drop if you notice nothing in 4 weeks.

7.3 Skip entirely (with one-line reasons)

- Fat burners (anything with "thermo," "shred," "lipo") — caffeine plus filler, often dosed dangerously, no advantage over coffee.
- CLA (conjugated linoleic acid) — meta-analyses show losses of 0.05 kg/week vs placebo at best, often null, with GI side effects.
- Raspberry ketones — animal model only, no human data at sane doses.
- Garcinia cambogia — null in human trials, hepatotoxic at high doses.
- BCAAs (as a standalone) — redundant if you hit total protein; whey already has them. (Wolfe 2017.)
- Detox teas / "cleanses" — laxatives. You will lose water and dignity, not fat.
- Apple cider vinegar pills — drink the vinegar in salad dressing; pills do nothing extra.
- Carnitine — small effects in carnitine-deficient populations only; null in healthy meat-eaters.

8. Troubleshooting (Fat-Loss Specific)

8.1 Scale stalled 2 weeks

The order is: **(a) audit, (b) cut food, (c) add steps, (d) reconsider deficit size.**

1. Re-weigh all food for 5 days. The average "stall" is a 200 kcal tracking creep — peanut butter spoons, dressing, oil splashes, restaurant guesses.
2. If audit is clean, cut 100–150 kcal from carbs only. Hold protein and fat.
3. If still flat after 1 more week, add 1500 steps/day before adding cardio. Walking is cheaper than recovery debt.

4. Only after (1)–(3) fail, consider that maintenance has dropped (metabolic adaptation, Trexler 2014) and cut another 100 kcal — but at this point, also pre-plan a 1-week diet break (see §8.7).
5. Do not add a fifth conditioning session or cut breakfast. Both wreck training and sleep.

8.2 Unmanageable hunger

Hunger ≠ failure. Hunger is the body asking for food. Manage it; don't moralize about it.

- Volume swaps: replace 50 g rice with 250 g cauliflower rice, replace beef with chicken breast at lunch, double the salad portion. Same kcal, twice the chew.
- Fiber: are you actually hitting 35–45 g? Add psyllium 5 g with the meal that hits hardest.
- Water: thirst masquerades as hunger. Drink 500 ml; wait 15 min.
- Sleep: under 7 hours and ghrelin spikes ~25%. Fix sleep before fixing diet.
- Protein: under 2.2 g/kg, hunger gets violent. Front-load protein at breakfast (40+ g).
- Diet soda / coffee: deploy mid-afternoon when willpower is lowest.
- Chew gum while cooking — most overeating happens during prep.
- Stop weighing yourself daily if it's driving you to undereat then binge. Move to weekly average.

8.3 Strength dropping

Some strength loss in a deficit is normal — 2–5% on top-end lifts. More than that is a flag.

- Protein audit: are you hitting 2.4 g/kg? Weigh it for 3 days.
- Sleep audit: under 7 hours, training output craters.
- Refeed audit: are you actually doing them at Week 5+? Many people skip out of fear of "ruining it."
- Volume audit: drop one set per exercise. Holding intensity (load) matters more than volume in a deficit.
- If all four are clean, your deficit is too aggressive — cut it by 100 kcal for two weeks.

8.4 Energy crash (3 pm / 5 pm wall)

- Carbs at lunch: are you eating a salad-only lunch and crashing later? Add 40 g rice or a piece of fruit.
- Electrolytes: sodium under 3 g/day is a guaranteed afternoon crash. Salt your eggs, salt your water.
- Caffeine timing: re-dose at 12:30 pm, not 3 pm (interferes with sleep).
- Cold water on the face, 5 min walk outside in sun. The biology of this is real.

8.5 Social events

The goal is to not derail a 12-week program for one dinner. Two real tools:

Calorie banking: cut 200 kcal/day for 3 days before the event — usually from fat (less oil, lean cuts only). Bank ~600 kcal. Save it for the dinner. Land back on plan the next morning. **Do not** bank more than 600 kcal — undereating before drinking is how people end up in the ER.

Alcohol rules: - Alcohol is **7 kcal/g** — closer to fat than to carbs. - Alcohol **acutely halts fat oxidation** for 8–12 hours while the liver clears it. Drink Friday, fat loss "pauses" until Saturday afternoon. - Two-drink ceiling. Choose: wine (130 kcal/150 ml), spirits + soda (90 kcal/45 ml), light beer (100 kcal/355 ml). Skip cocktails (300+ kcal/glass), cream liqueurs, and beer after the second. - Drink water 1:1 between drinks. Eat protein-anchored food while drinking (not after). - **Never drink the day before a heavy lift.** Sleep architecture wrecks for 36 hours.

Restaurant tactics at events: see §6.

8.6 Plateau on weight but inches dropping

This is **good**. Body recomposition is real, especially in months 2–3 of training for intermediate lifters in a moderate deficit. Trust the tape measure and clothing fit over the scale for 2 weeks. If photos and tape both stall for 2 weeks, return to §8.1.

8.7 Optional diet break

At **Week 6** or **Week 10** (your choice — pick the harder one psychologically), take a **7-day diet break at maintenance** (~+450 kcal/day, all from carbs and a little fat). This is not a cheat week. Track food at maintenance.

- Restores thyroid output (T3) and leptin.
- Improves training output for the rest of the block.
- Improves long-term adherence — the people who do diet breaks finish the program.
- Expect 0.5–1.5 kg scale bump from glycogen + water. It is not fat. It will come off in 7 days back in deficit.

Reference: Byrne et al. 2018 (MATADOR study) showed intermittent (2-on, 2-off) dieting preserved more lean mass and produced greater fat loss than continuous dieting over the same total deficit days. We use a single mid-program break because adherence is the real fight.

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End of companion. Cook the food. Hit the macros. Walk every day. The plan works if you work the plan.